

20 Tech Trends Taking Over 2020

What's to come in tech
later this year?



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In 2019 we saw the growth of technologies aiming for a more connected society. From new plans to use current tech in innovative ways, to the growth of new techniques that increase connectivity and kick start the decade with innovation. This year it's going to be focused on one thing and one thing only: the transformative power of tech!

We put together a list of the top trends that will change our lives in the next year. From simple tech that we're hearing everywhere (we're looking at you 5G!) to more innovative tech trends like extended reality.

An overwhelming theme among them is communication and symbiosis where human and tech work together like never before. Digital technologies and machines are sharing information, learning, and augmenting humans in new and exciting ways. And we're here for it!

Let's jump in to the list of tech trends what are taking over this year:

IoT — Internet of Things

IoT is a digital system or network made entirely of devices and machines without humans. IoT isn't a new concept (it's been around for nearly 16 years after being coined by Kevin Ashton) but 2020 will bring IoT upfront and make it even more mainstream with new applications: using AI with IoT we can transmit and interpret data faster than before and get real time results.

IoT is leading the way in the development of smart cities and everything from workforce management and every day urban interactions, to data management, security, fintech, healthcare and more.

AI — Artificial Intelligence

As we enter 2020 AI (Artificial Intelligence) is prominent in day to day lives with an ever growing interest. What is AI exactly? It's a technology that is created to react like humans in learning and problem solving. AI is prevalent in the consumer market with online bots, online adverts, search engines, automobiles and more.

Programs using AI can solve problems and react in real time allowing processes to run past human ability. In 2020 we will see more in AI human interaction. How? AI can assist doctors in healthcare, for example: consulting possible diagnostics according to signs and symptoms and selecting the best treatments. Expect AI to scale and expand in the workplace and beyond to home alternatives!

Blockchain

Blockchain is a digital database and transaction record that omits a third party, in which the record is permanent in the shape of blocks of information. Transactions are contingent on the prior events of the chain, which lends the term Blockchain.

Blockchain is going to evolve from proof of concept to widespread practical use throughout markets. Currently its largely associated with cryptocurrency, but will expand to smart contracts, fraud prevention and even industries like farming. As IoT develops and devices are more connected, blockchain will provide the necessary security and logging within the networks, helping keep a permanent record.

Cryptocurrency

Cryptocurrency took off in the mainstream community in the last two years, and 2020 will see the continuation and advancement of the crypto trend throughout different markets. Crypto derivatives have grown and will continue to grow in 2020 giving investors more options.

Blockchain based crypto evolved to a layer-2 payment protocol known as lightning network. In 2020 the lightning infrastructure will be built upon to be more secure and efficient, with blockchain guaranteeing encrypted record-keeping for all transactions.

Sustainability

Sustainability has been leading tech trends for a few years, and 2020 is no different. New technologies are being developed to mitigate the effects of existing environmental hazards, for example: researchers are working on chemical recycling for plastics! With the use of AI and IoT energy resources will be used more efficiently.

The agriculture industry will take advantage of AI and human augmentation. Robots and drones will be more normalized in the harvesting of crops. Agriculture companies will be able to use AI to monitor crops and enhance growth.

5G Tech

5G is already dominating headlines and carriers are announcing broad 5G coverage all across the most important markets. But what is it exactly? 5G doesn't just mean faster speeds of transmission and coverage: it is an overhaul of how all devices connect.

5G will bring IoT into automobiles, appliances, and more devices as tech advances. The ultra-low latency will allow safe remote control of large appliances that previously posed a risk to human operators.

Digital Banking

Traditional banks are being eked out by cryptocurrency and digital payment systems like Venmo and Google Pay. In order to survive the changing financial landscape, banks need to adapt. Institutions are partnering with digital transfer platforms like Zelle and incorporating blockchain into operations.

Brick and mortar institutions will continue to disappear as the digital takes over, leading to expansion in the digital banking alternatives for users. It opens the pathways for more efficient apps and web platforms!

Automation

Automation is ready to get to the next level in 2020. AI, Machine Learning and IoT integration will deliver more advanced solutions adjusting to the market demand. Unlike AI on its own, automation is reliant on human interaction at some point through the process, creating a system that relies on live support.

Automation isn't able to advance beyond its current task without input, it is a programming alternative that operates on the age-old if/then process. Automation advancements will be seen in marketing, healthcare, automobiles and the labor force.

Distributed Cloud

Distributed cloud is the distribution of public clouds outside the data center, but still controlled by the provider. This allows businesses and other organization to diversify their strategy, picking and choosing the best applications already in existence to create a unique and seamless experience for their users.

In 2020 the sharing economy is going to be a priority and the distributed cloud model allows for easy sharing without losing intellectual ownership, all this while relying heavily on distributed tech and blockchain.

Extended Reality

Extended reality, VR and AR, took over consumer market the last 5 years with Snapchat filters, the Oculus and gaming systems. In 2020 the excitement will fall in industrial applications. VR can simulate dangerous training in fields like engineering and help med students practice procedures without putting patients at risk.

On the consumer front with the rise of 5G we will see more personal devices without the need for a large processor. This will create a more innovative methodology and increase the distribution without relying on bulkier devices, aiding in the democratization the usage of extended reality on a daily setting.

In Shokworks we're always looking for ways to implement innovative tech trends to current problems, offering a new take in the shape of taylor-made tech solutions. Join us and find out how complex concepts can become your simple solutions.

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